

Standard Operating Procedure

Physical Restraint Use

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.16.e (Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» uses physical restraints only when necessary, with a proper order, monitoring, and the least invasive option.

2. Scope

Applies to any patient for whom physical restraint is being considered or used, in any area of the hospital.

3. Responsibility

Treating Doctor: orders the restraint, states the reason and time frame, and reassesses at the required interval.

Nursing Staff: monitors the patient per the defined frequency and documents each episode.

4. Procedure

1. Identify the specific situation requiring restraint, per the hospital's written criteria — restraint is never a default response to agitation or non-compliance.
2. Select the least invasive option that addresses the situation — never the most restrictive option by default.
3. Obtain a clinical order before or at initiation — never apply a restraint and seek the order afterward, except in a genuine emergency, documented immediately.
4. Document the reason for use and the time frame of use for every episode — both elements are required, every time.
5. Monitor the patient at the defined frequency for circulation, skin integrity, and continued need for the restraint.
6. Reassess before the order expires — a restraint order is never open-ended.
7. Explain to the family and obtain consent where statutory requirements call for it.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not apply a restraint without a clinical order, except in a genuine emergency where the order is obtained immediately afterward and documented as such.

Do not continue a restraint past its ordered time frame without reassessment and a fresh order.

Raising a restraint applied without an order, or continued without reassessment, is not a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Records 6, 7, and 8 of the COP.16 Required Records pack.

7. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_16_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.16 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any restraint-related injury or complaint.